



Setup and longevity

One-hour setup for security, performance, and trouble-free use

Congratulations on your new laptop! The first hour with a Windows 11 PC is crucial for laying the groundwork for security, performance, and longevity. Follow this step-by-step 60-minute plan to configure essential settings and eliminate potential issues right out of the box.

1. **Complete initial setup and remove bloatware:** After finishing the out-of-box experience (OOBE) and creating your account, take a moment to uninstall any preloaded bloatware or trial software you don't need. Many new PCs come with trial antivirus suites or software you might not use – removing these can free up resources and reduce annoying pop-ups. (If you plan to use Windows Security (Defender) as your antivirus, it's perfectly fine to uninstall third-party AV trials to avoid conflicts.)
2. **Sign in with a Microsoft account:** If you haven't already, sign in to Windows 11 with your Microsoft account (or create one). This enables device encryption by default on many new laptops and stores the recovery key to your online account. It also lets you sync settings and easily integrate OneDrive cloud backup. Note: Windows 11 Home edition requires a Microsoft account during setup, so most new laptops will have this by default. If you used a local account, consider switching to a Microsoft account for these benefits.
3. **Perform all Windows updates:** Ensure your new system is fully updated. Even if Windows 11 is set to auto-update, it's wise to manually check for updates to catch any critical fixes or driver updates that might be missing. Go to Settings > Windows Update and click "Check for updates." Install